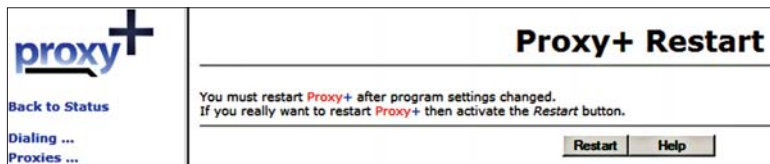


mail clients, they're actually downloading it from the proxy server instead of from the Internet. The same applies to sending e-mails.

In order to set Proxy+ to handle mail, go to Mail > General and set the outgoing SMTP server first. Choose Internet Mail Server if your server is an online one. Usually, just choosing your ISP's SMTP server is recommended. Next go to Mail > POP3 General and check the POP3 Downloader enabled box. Now you can go to Mail > POP3 Download, add the Internet mail account for any of the local users you have. Add in the e-mail account, username, password, and select whether you want messages to be left on the server or downloaded. Click Save.

After you're done adding all the accounts, you can restart Proxy+ to make the changes active. To configure your mail client, just set the POP and SMTP servers to the IP address of the computer that Proxy+ is running on. You also need to use the authentication (username and password) that is stored in Proxy+ for your username. So, if Proxy+ is installed on a machine with the IP 192.168.0.1, your name is Prakash Sharma, your e-mail address is p.sharma@yourdomain.com, your Proxy+ username is psharma and password is pwd, your mail client settings would be:

Account Name: Prakash Sharma (or anything you want)



Remember to restart Proxy+ for major changes to take effect

E-mail Address: p.sharma@your domain.com

Incoming Server: 192.168.0.1

Outgoing Server: 192.168.0.1 (providing you have set your SMTP server in Proxy+, otherwise just use your regular SMTP server)

Username: psharma (the Proxy+ username)

Password: pwd (Proxy+ password, not your e-mail account password)

Access Lists

If you decide that not everyone requires access to the proxy server, you can deny access based on IP addresses—for example, you might not want anyone in the accounts department to get Net

Using the Access List, you can set Allow and Deny based on the time of day

access, to prevent exposure to viruses. Using the Access List, you can also set Allow and Deny based on the time of day—so, for example, you can allow Net access only during working hours (say, 9 AM and 7 PM), or even deny access to everyone during lunch hours (known as goofing off time). You can also set rules on a per-IP basis.

First, you need to go to Access List > General and tick the "Enable Access List" checkbox. Click save and then move on to Access List > Objects. You need to read carefully if you want to be able to allow or deny access to computers or set time restrictions. Although what follows may look like scripting, it's not. It's just a logical way of telling the proxy what to do.

First we'll look at Objects. Here you will see a dropdown box called New object type. If you want the proxy to deny the IP 192.168.0.99 access, you need to first define that IP. This is exactly what you will do at Objects.

The three types of objects that are most commonly used are ClientHostName, ClientIP and Time. If the IP 192.168.0.99 belongs to a computer called Prakash, this is the ClientHostName. Now to define this, you will add an identifier under New object name. For the computer Prakash, you might want to set the object name to say, PC99, or anything descriptive that will help you identify the object. Under Parameter, you need to add Prakash and select ClientHostName from the New object type drop-down. When you click Add, you will see that it is saved in the format PC99 = ClientHostName; Prakash.

Let's say you now want to add an IP—say, 192.168.0.125—as an Object. You need to select ClientIP from the New object type drop down, enter 192.168.0.125 as the parameter, and anything descriptive that you will remember as the New object name—IP125, for example. This will add the line IP125 = ClientIP; 192.168.0.125.

You can define time similarly—for example, choosing the time between 11:00 AM and 1:00 PM, and calling it Lunch would give you the following line in the Defined Objects list: Lunch = Time; 11:00-13:00.

Once you have defined Objects, you can choose what the Access List does to them. There are four commands the List understands: Allow, Deny, Pass and Rewrite. The first two are self-explanatory. Pass is a rule that allows a con-

Alternatives

FreeProxy

Available from www.handcraftedsoftware.org, FreeProxy is, well, free! Made for the Windows platform, it offers all the important features that you want: content filtering (keyword/URL, etc.), time based access, user-based access control, auto-dialling, access report generation, caching (v3.80 onwards), a Web server, ability to run as a service, etc. It offers almost all the same functionality as Proxy+, and at an unbeatable price—Rs 0. It's ideal for smaller companies though—10 users or less—according to prominent software reviewers, and seems to perform less efficiently as the number of users increase. Still, the software is still being actively and passionately developed, and FreeProxy is by far the most popular Windows-based proxy server. If you have 15 or less PCs in your company, look no further than FreeProxy.

Squid

If you have a PC to spare, and are familiar with Linux, you should definitely look at Squid. This open source proxy server is the *de facto* choice of larger businesses. With all the features you can imagine, stability that's unbeatable and the capability of handling thousands of concurrent connections without overloading the CPU, nothing beats Squid in terms of scalability. The only drawback for the average Indian SoHo office is the need for a machine running Linux—however, with Linux gaining popularity amongst PC enthusiasts and *Digit* readers, we expect Squid to gain a few popularity points over the years. You can download it, or read more about it at the Squid Web site: www.squid-cache.org.